

bunch of websites going the open source way when it came to security. The new Passie was also pretty inconsistent and logging in was never the same again.

This story teaches us one very valuable lesson and prompts us to give you one solid piece of advice. The former is that remembering the passwords to all your accounts is nigh impossible and using the same password for every account is a pretty stupid idea. Even if you are an eighty year old grandmother of seven and just getting the hand of the world wide web. In the event some malicious hacker gets a hold of your password and other credentials from one website, his or her (yes, girls can be hackers too) first reaction would be to try it out at all the possible places you might frequent and gain access.

So it is at this point that we feel we should introduce you to the magical world of (say it with us now,) Password Managers.

Huh?

If you involuntarily grunted that that syllable, a password manager is an application that organises the different passwords you use. Each account has its own entry and some will auto-fill forms with credentials you have entered previously. They are also smart enough to tell if the website you're on is the real deal or not too. These passwords can be stored locally or on the cloud. Quite a few come as browser plug-ins and equal number, if not more as smartphone apps. Some even manage PIN numbers for you and all of these passwords are kept perfectly safe by a very strong master password.

“A very strong master password that anybody can guess/ get out of you and steal all the money in your bank account(s),” said most of the people that read the last line of the previous paragraph. But here is where the devs have outsmarted us once again. While all (we hope) password managers require a master password for access, a few can be plugged in to fingerprint scanners and a few even use Google's Authenticator, which generates one time codes and sends it to your mobile. There's an app for that too by the way.

Can ya tell me more son?

To talk in detail about all the different password managers out there is a difficult task. One can recite names off a list ad nauseum and the list will still keep going and you'd be left with a messy floor. Instead, allow us to introduce you to a few that truly outshine the software that jumped on board the 'me too' wagon or are sold as part of bundles.